

**August 2025. We asked
Amity's teachers what
worried them most about AI.**

“Cheating.”

Seven months later, their students
were writing something else.



After a session on generative AI, one student wrote:

EXIT TICKET · GRADE 8

SESSION 11 · GEN AI & LEARNING

“ChatGPT is a tool. I'm the one who still has to think.”

Seven months earlier, the adults in this student's school were worried AI would do students' thinking for them.

Here's what happened in between →

THE DECISION

The superintendent's call: train the teachers first.

Amity is a rural district of about 756 students. Before a single student lesson, Superintendent Jeff Clark had the staff trained.

AUG 2025

40 educators trained

First-year teachers to 31-year veterans. Wood shop, agriculture, special ed, a principal.

OCT 2025

8th grade course begins

Led by Amity teacher Darcy Hatch

JAN 2026

9th grade course begins

Led by Amity teacher Jill Whitehead

132 students

15 sessions per grade

60 minutes each

WHERE STUDENTS STARTED

**Before the course, we surveyed
65 freshmen.**

82% could tell helpful AI from harmful AI



25% felt capable of creating anything with
it



High awareness. Low agency.

WHAT CLASS LOOKED LIKE

Every session, students built, tested or argued.

01 Trained their own image classifiers

in Teachable Machine, using their own faces

02 Played Semantris

to see how a language model connects words

03 Audited their own TikTok feeds

What has the algorithm decided about me?

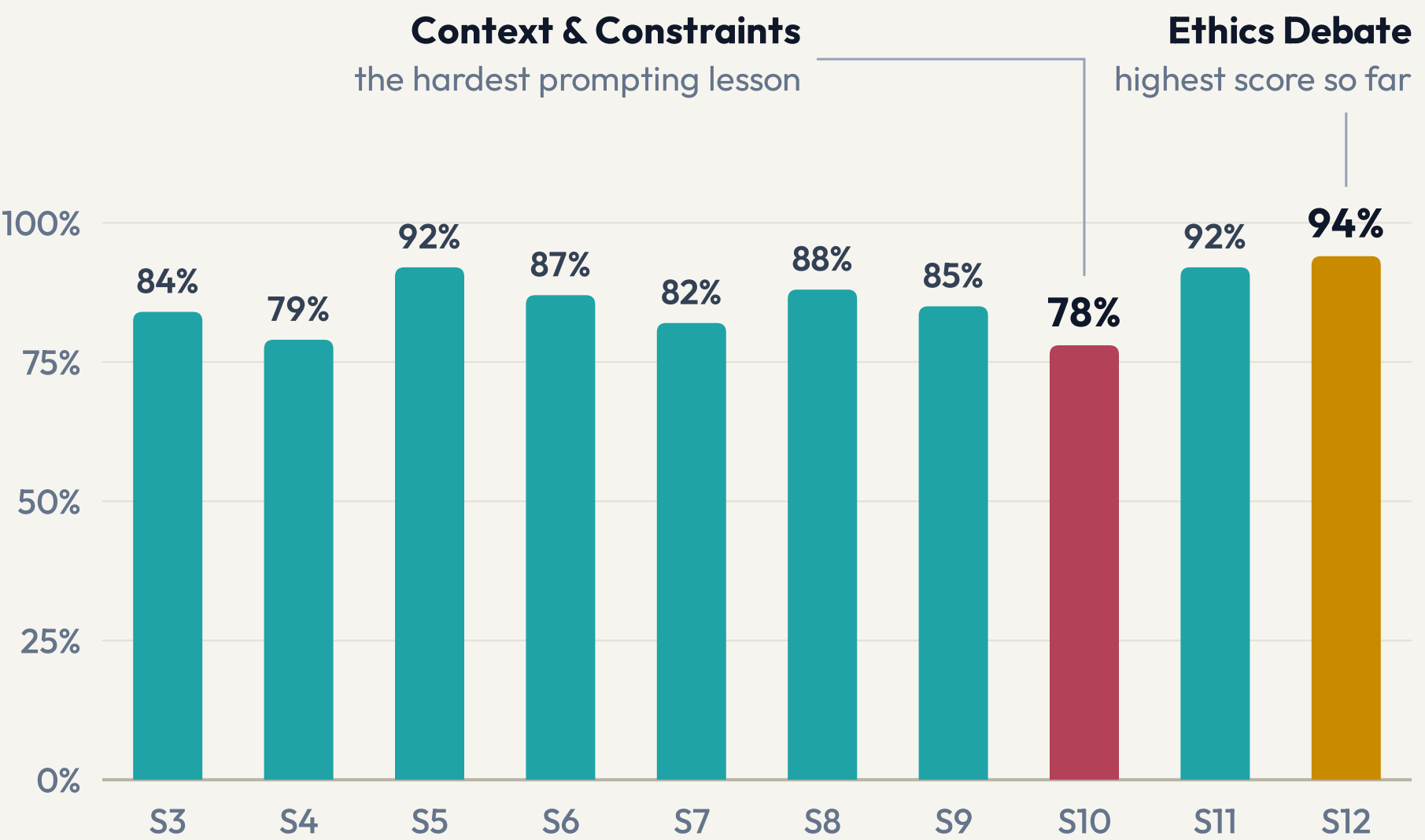
04 Took on an ethics question every week

Privacy, ownership, bias, who benefits and who pays

Taught by Amity's own teachers, not computer science specialists.

87% average pass rate. Including one hard week.

Share of students scoring 3 or higher (out of 5) on each session's exit ticket, sessions 3–12. Data as of March 2026.



4.25 / 5

average score, 10 sessions

456

exit tickets scored

THE TOP-SCORING LESSON

The top-scoring 8th grade session had no right answer.

4.6/5

Ethics Debate, avg score

94%

scored 3 or higher

EXIT TICKET • GRADE 8

SESSION 12 • ETHICS DEBATE

“The ethics debate was hard because both sides had a real point. That's what real decisions feel like.”

Teachers feared AI would do the thinking. In their first few sessions, 9th graders wrote:

EXIT TICKET · GRADE 9

SESSION 4 · HALLUCINATIONS

“Use AI for ideas not for answers.”

EXIT TICKET · GRADE 9

SESSION 1 · AI, THE SYSTEM

“AI is a smart tool that makes things easier for you but makes your brain slower if you rely on it too much.”

AND THE TEACHERS

93%

of educators surveyed after training reported a stronger understanding of AI in education.

“Post Tomo AI Training, educators are sharing new AI tools or strategies with each other.”

Mary Matocha, Principal, Amity Middle School



Reviewed by Superintendent Jeff Clark and cleared for sharing

Read the full case study.

Session-by-session scores, the baseline survey and the complete curriculum for grades 8 and 9.

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The full story is on our Substack: **tomoclub.substack.com**